

Buyer Fit: Apogee

Current target

Apogee is the current primary strategic target for GIG / System Q.

The reason is not just that Apogee is an audio company. The fit is that Apogee already owns credibility where System Q needs to feel serious first:

- Premium recording interfaces
- Pristine conversion
- Artist and producer trust
- Professional desktop and studio workflows
- High-end audio quality without a mass-market feel

System Q should be presented as a way for Apogee to expand from trusted recording hardware into a broader musician ecosystem.

Why Apogee may fit better than a broad manufacturing buyer

A broad buyer can manufacture across many categories, but System Q needs early credibility around sound, workflow, and professional trust.

Apogee is narrower than Music Tribe, but that can be an advantage for the first strategic conversation:

- The recording-quality promise is easier to understand.
- The premium positioning is already native to the brand.
- The system can start from interface/conversion/workflow before expanding into the full ecosystem.
- The product does not have to be framed as a low-cost mass rollout first.

The strongest Apogee framing is not "build every piece immediately."

The stronger framing is:

System Q extends Apogee's recording trust into a connected musician environment: personal station, recording path, tactile control, software recall, and venue playback.

Bob Clearmountain access path

Bob Clearmountain is the current strategic access path.

He should not be treated as a generic reviewer. His value is the combination of:

- Deep recording and mixing authority

- Ability to judge whether the system feels credible to serious audio people
- Potential access into Apogee leadership
- Enough reputation that a positive read could materially change the next conversation

The ask should be direct and narrow:

- Does the System Q / GIG architecture make sense as a musician recording ecosystem?
- Do the four hooks land quickly?
- Does the Apogee framing feel credible?
- What would block this from being taken seriously by Apogee?
- If it does land, is there a right way to put it in front of Apogee?

Four hooks to lead with

The Apogee-facing version should lead with:

1. Sound without dependency
2. Historic input cards
3. Historic output / print cards
4. Tape Cylinder magnetic buffer
5. 6-DOF Console control
6. Venue mix-level playback and room translation

For Apogee, the first hook should be tied to trust:

Apogee already owns the front end of trusted recording. System Q asks what happens if that trust becomes the spine of the whole musician workflow.

The analog-card story should be concrete:

- Input cards let the user record through historic capture identities: Abbey Road-inspired, Sausalito Record Plant/API-inspired, Zeppelin Mobile/Neve-inspired, Zappa UMRK/Harrison-Trident-inspired, and Tom Scholz Basement-inspired paths.
- Output cards let the user print or play back through historic mix/output identities: SSL bus-inspired, RCA New York Church-inspired, Les Paul Studio-inspired, Bill Putnam/United-inspired, Abbey Road-inspired, and Power Station-inspired paths.
- The Tape Cylinder can sit on the input path, output path, or both, acting as a magnetic overload buffer before conversion or print.

What not to lead with

Do not lead Apogee or Bob with:

- AIP
- Civilizational framing
- A giant all-at-once product universe
- A claim that every hardware detail is final
- A generic acquisition ask

Those layers may matter later, but the first door is sound, workflow, and strategic fit.

Recommended first ask to Bob

The first ask should be:

I am shaping System Q / GIG as a connected musician recording ecosystem and I think Apogee may be the right strategic home. Before I put it in front of Apogee directly, I want your blunt read on whether the architecture and product story are credible enough to deserve that conversation.

The point is not encouragement.

The point is to learn whether Bob sees enough there to help it reach Apogee in the right form.

Relationship to Music Tribe

Music Tribe / Behringer remains a plausible secondary buyer profile because the system spans many categories.

But the active strategy has shifted:

- Primary target: Apogee
- Primary access path: Bob Clearmountain
- Secondary broad-platform buyer context: Music Tribe / Behringer